



Develop and implement operational policies

D1.HGE.CL7.14

D1.HGA.CL6.13

D2.TGA.CL6.10

Trainee Manual



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Trainee Manual



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The Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) was established on 8 August 1967. The Member States of the Association are Brunei Darussalam, Cambodia, Indonesia, Lao PDR, Malaysia, Myanmar, Philippines, Singapore, Thailand and Viet Nam.

The ASEAN Secretariat is based in Jakarta, Indonesia.

General Information on ASEAN appears online at the ASEAN Website: www.asean.org.

All text is produced by William Angliss Institute of TAFE for the ASEAN Project on “Toolbox Development for Tourism Labour Divisions for Travel Agencies and Tour Operations”.

This publication is supported by the Australian Government’s aid program through the ASEAN-Australia Development Cooperation Program Phase II (AADCP II).

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File name: TM Develop and implement operational policies_291015



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Introduction to trainee manual

To the Trainee

Congratulations on joining this course. This Trainee Manual is one part of a 'toolbox' which is a resource provided to trainees, trainers and assessors to help you become competent in various areas of your work.

The 'toolbox' consists of three elements:

- A Trainee Manual for you to read and study at home or in class
- A Trainer Guide with Power Point slides to help your Trainer explain the content of the training material and provide class activities to help with practice
- An Assessment Manual which provides your Assessor with oral and written questions and other assessment tasks to establish whether or not you have achieved competency.

The first thing you may notice is that this training program and the information you find in the Trainee Manual seems different to the textbooks you have used previously. This is because the method of instruction and examination is different. The method used is called Competency based training (CBT) and Competency based assessment (CBA). CBT and CBA is the training and assessment system chosen by ASEAN (Association of South-East Asian Nations) to train people to work in the tourism and hospitality industry throughout all the ASEAN member states.

What is the CBT and CBA system and why has it been adopted by ASEAN?

CBT is a way of training that concentrates on what a worker can do or is required to do at work. The aim of the training is to enable trainees to perform tasks and duties at a standard expected by employers. CBT seeks to develop the skills, knowledge and attitudes (or recognise the ones the trainee already possesses) to achieve the required competency standard. ASEAN has adopted the CBT/CBA training system as it is able to produce the type of worker that industry is looking for and this therefore increases trainee chances of obtaining employment.

CBA involves collecting evidence and making a judgement of the extent to which a worker can perform his/her duties at the required competency standard. Where a trainee can already demonstrate a degree of competency, either due to prior training or work experience, a process of 'Recognition of Prior Learning' (RPL) is available to trainees to recognise this. Please speak to your trainer about RPL if you think this applies to you.

What is a competency standard?

Competency standards are descriptions of the skills and knowledge required to perform a task or activity at the level of a required standard.

242 competency standards for the tourism and hospitality industries throughout the ASEAN region have been developed to cover all the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to work in the following occupational areas:

- Housekeeping
- Food Production
- Food and Beverage Service
- Front Office

- Travel Agencies
- Tour Operations.

All of these competency standards are available for you to look at. In fact you will find a summary of each one at the beginning of each Trainee Manual under the heading 'Unit Descriptor'. The unit descriptor describes the content of the unit you will be studying in the Trainee Manual and provides a table of contents which are divided up into 'Elements' and 'Performance Criteria'. An element is a description of one aspect of what has to be achieved in the workplace. The 'Performance Criteria' below each element details the level of performance that needs to be demonstrated to be declared competent.

There are other components of the competency standard:

- *Unit Title*: statement about what is to be done in the workplace
- *Unit Number*: unique number identifying the particular competency
- *Nominal hours*: number of classroom or practical hours usually needed to complete the competency. We call them 'nominal' hours because they can vary e.g. sometimes it will take an individual less time to complete a unit of competency because he/she has prior knowledge or work experience in that area.

The final heading you will see before you start reading the Trainee Manual is the 'Assessment Matrix'. Competency based assessment requires trainees to be assessed in at least 2 – 3 different ways, one of which must be practical. This section outlines three ways assessment can be carried out and includes work projects, written questions and oral questions. The matrix is designed to show you which performance criteria will be assessed and how they will be assessed. Your trainer and/or assessor may also use other assessment methods including 'Observation Checklist' and 'Third Party Statement'. An observation checklist is a way of recording how you perform at work and a third party statement is a statement by a supervisor or employer about the degree of competence they believe you have achieved. This can be based on observing your workplace performance, inspecting your work or gaining feedback from fellow workers.

Your trainer and/or assessor may use other methods to assess you such as:

- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Role plays
- Log books
- Group projects
- Practical demonstrations.

Remember your trainer is there to help you succeed and become competent. Please feel free to ask him or her for more explanation of what you have just read and of what is expected from you and best wishes for your future studies and future career in tourism and hospitality.

Unit descriptor

Develop and implement operational policies

This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to Develop and implement operational policies in a range of settings within the travel industries workplace context.

Unit Code:

D1.HGE.CL7.14

D1.HGA.CL6.13

D2.TGA.CL6.10

Nominal Hours:

60

Element 1: Develop operational policies

Performance Criteria

- 1.1 Develop operational policies and strategies based on monitoring of workplace needs and identification of opportunities for improvement and innovation
- 1.2 Develop scope and objectives of the required initiative based on enterprise goals, staff and customer feedback
- 1.3 Identify and analyse internal and external factors that may impact on the policy
- 1.4 Consult appropriate stakeholders during the development of the policy
- 1.5 Develop appropriate and financially-sound resource strategies
- 1.6 Develop administrative framework and systems capable of supporting the planned initiative
- 1.7 Identify and communicate clearly all priorities, responsibilities and timelines
- 1.8 Develop evaluation systems in consultation with appropriate colleagues

Element 2: Administer and monitor operational policy

Performance Criteria

- 2.1 Implement and evaluate identified actions in accordance with agreed priorities
- 2.2 Monitor performance indicators
- 2.3 Provide progress and other reports in accordance with enterprise requirements
- 2.4 Make assessment of the need for additional resource requirements and take appropriate action in accordance with enterprise policy

Element 3: Conduct ongoing evaluation

Performance Criteria

- 3.1 Review the operational policy to assess effectiveness in the workplace
- 3.2 Monitor performance
- 3.3 Identify problems and make adjustments accordingly
- 3.4 Incorporate the results of evaluation into ongoing planning and operational management

Assessment matrix

Showing mapping of Performance Criteria against Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions

The Assessment Matrix indicates three of the most common assessment activities your Assessor may use to assess your understanding of the content of this manual and your performance - Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions. It also indicates where you can find the subject content related to these assessment activities in the Trainee Manual (i.e. under which element or performance criteria). As explained in the Introduction, however, the assessors are free to choose which assessment activities are most suitable to best capture evidence of competency as they deem appropriate for individual students.

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 1: : Develop operational policies				
1.1	Develop operational polices and strategies based on monitoring of workplace needs and identification of opportunities for improvement and innovation	1.1	1 – 5	1
1.2	Develop scope and objectives of the required initiative based on enterprise goals, staff and customer feedback	1.1	6, 7, 8	2
1.3	Identify and analyse internal and external factors that may impact on the policy	1.1	9, 19, 11	3
1.4	Consult appropriate stakeholders during the development of the policy	1.1	12	4
1.5	Develop appropriate and financially-sound resource strategies	1.1	13 – 16	5
1.6	Develop administrative framework and systems capable of supporting the planned initiative	1.1	17, 18	6
1.7	Identify and communicate clearly all priorities, responsibilities and timelines	1.1	19, 20	7
1.8	Develop evaluation systems in consultation with appropriate colleagues	1.1	21, 22	8

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 2: Administer and monitor operational policy				
2.1	Implement and evaluate identified actions in accordance with agreed priorities	2.1	23, 24, 25	9
2.2	Monitor performance indicators	2.1	26, 27	10
2.3	Provide progress and other reports in accordance with enterprise requirements	2.1	28, 29, 30	11
2.4	Make assessment of the need for additional resource requirements and take appropriate action in accordance with enterprise policy	2.1	31, 32	12
Element 3: : Conduct ongoing evaluation				
3.1	Review the operational policy to assess effectiveness in the workplace	3.1	33, 34	13
3.2	Monitor performance	3.1	35, 36	14
3.3	Identify problems and make adjustments accordingly	3.1	37, 38	15
3.4	Incorporate the results of evaluation into ongoing planning and operational management	3.1	39, 40	16

Glossary

Term	Explanation
Assets Register	A document/database where assets are recorded and their use is tracked/monitored/recorded
CMS	Customer (Client) Management System
CSI	Customer Satisfaction Index
KPI	Key Performance Indicator
OSH	Occupational safety and health
PESTEL analysis	Same as SLEPT analysis with addition of Environmental factors
Q&A session	Question and Answer session
QA	Quality Assurance
ROI	Return On Investment
SLEPT analysis	Analysis of a situation looking at the Social, Legal, economic, political and technological factors
SMART goals/objectives	Goals/objectives which are Specific, Measurable, Accurate, Realistic, Time-related
SOP	Standard Operating Procedure
STEEPLE analysis	Same as PESTEL analysis with addition of ethical factors
SWOT	Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities and Threats
Stakeholders	People/organisations with a stake/interest in a decision or policy
TNA	Training Needs Analysis
USP	Unique Selling Point/Proposition

Element 1:

Develop operational policies

1.1 Develop operational policies and strategies based on monitoring of workplace needs and identification of opportunities for improvement and innovation

Introduction

The operational policies and strategies for an organisation need to reflect identified needs of the business opportunities open to it and the direction it wants to take.

This section provides a context for the unit, discusses operational 'policies' and 'strategies', identifies areas to which operational policies and strategies might apply, and explains how monitoring of workplace needs and opportunities for improvement and innovation might be identified.



Unit context

An organisation involved in the development and implementation of operational policies will typically be one where:

- The organisation has a formal set of plans – which may include:
 - A business plan
 - Strategic plans
 - Tactical plans
 - Operational plans
 - Contingency plans
- The policies of the organisation need to:
 - Reflect the plans which have been developed for the business
 - Flow directly from the plans
 - Support attainment of the goals and objectives identified in the plans
- The procedures of the organisation are:
 - Driven by the statements made in relevant policies
 - In accordance with policies
 - Directly linked to the public statements the organisation makes about itself (in terms of its Mission Statement, Vision Statement and Core Values statement).

Websites

See more detailed information on different business plans at:

- <http://study.com/academy/lesson/types-of-planning-strategic-tactical-operational-contingency-planning.html>
- <https://blog.udemy.com/planning-in-management/>
- <https://www.boundless.com/management/textbooks/boundless-management-textbook/control-8/types-of-control-62/strategic-tactical-and-operational-control-313-3960/>



Operational – defined

It is necessary to understand the word 'operational' in this context means/refers to:

- Day-to-day activities of the business
- Daily actions employees/managers need to take
- Frequent decisions within the business which need to be made
- Topics which are of ongoing concern to the organisation
- Activities which are fundamental to the processes necessary for the business to function (operate) as required/intended.



Operational policies – defined

Operational policies (generally) have the following characteristics – they:

- Flow from the plans of the business
- Represent the thinking/philosophy of the business
- Define the position of the organisation on a matter by giving insight into its stance and orientation on issues which are covered by the policy
- Are developed before procedures
- State the intention and expectations of the organisation and staff in relation to the subject that is the title of the policy
- Explain what the organisation wants to achieve
- Define and describe how the organisation (and, by extension, its employees) will act in given situations, if/when they arise
- Are the 'rules' the organisation seeks to operate by
- Give consistency in the way the organisation operates
- Contain a statement explaining the reason the policy has been prepared
- Provide guidance to employees about what the organisation wants – and how workers should act to help achieve that outcome
- Identify responsibilities for taking action to achieve the desired outcomes
- Prescribe timing considerations relevant to the issue

- Resolve anticipated problems in relation to the policy topic
- Identify documentation to be used or completed in relation to the topic, if/where necessary
- Contain information on legal and regulatory requirements the organisation must meet, if applicable
- Align with other public statements the organisation makes about itself
- Should be formalised by being *written* documents – rather than simply existing in the minds of management in order that:
 - There is no confusion about what they say
 - They can be readily shared among the workforce.

Standard content of policies

It is common for policies to contain the following elements/headings:

- Name/title of the policy
- Purpose of the policy – explaining why the policy has been developed
- Scope of the policy – identifying who the policy applies to/who is bound by it
- Date the policy applies – the date the policy becomes/became effective
- Legislative authority – specifying statutes which govern implementation of the policy (if applicable – many operational are subject to legislation, and many are not)
- Policy statement/s – statement/s indicating:
 - How *this* policy fits with others and with the overall operation of the business
 - Relevant commitments by management to specifics of the policy
 - Description/s of processes inherent in implementing the policy
- Responsibilities for action – giving names/titles of those with specific responsibility under the policy in areas such as, for example:
 - Compliance
 - Monitoring
 - Review
 - Record management
 - Reporting
- Consequences of non-compliance
- Definitions – in relation to policy-specific terms
- Version control information.



Websites

Check out:

- http://www.industrialrelations.nsw.gov.au/oirwww/Employment_info/Managing_employees/Workplace_policies_and_procedures.page - Workplace policies and procedures
- http://www.industrialrelations.nsw.gov.au/biz_res/oirwww/pdfs/workplace_pp.pdf - Workplace policies and procedures.

Strategies

Strategies (generally) have the following characteristics – they:

- Flow from the plans of the business
- Identify the goals the organisation has set for itself
- Quantify the objectives to be achieved
- Describe ways to achieve what is required
- Give direction to the course the organisation is to take
- Guide decisions managers/supervisors need to make about the operation of the business
- Must align with requirements of applicable policies
- Will need to be ethical *and* comply with public statements the organisation makes about itself
- Provide a plan of action about what needs to be done
- May indicate different ways/a range of options to achieve the one goal, objective or target
- Give a context for organisational procedures in relation to achieving pertinent objectives – meaning an SOP may be acceptable in one context, but unacceptable in another.



Content

There are no formal or mandatory requirements for the content of operational strategies but it is commonly held they should:

- Address ways in which the organisation intends to target the customer and deliver the product or service it has to offer so the customer is more likely to deal with the organisation.

This refers to the marketing- based concept whereby 'The Customer' is at the centre of all organisational thinking and actions and the business seeks to adjust how it applies its available resources to service 'The Customer'.

The available resources being 'The 5Ps of Marketing':

- Prices it charges
- Promotions it undertakes
- Places it sells from
- Products it offers
- People it uses.

- Present ways in which the business proposes, as appropriate to its individual need at this point in time, to address the five performance objectives (identified by Slack and Lewis in *Operations Strategy* [3rd edition], 2011, p. 16) of:
 - Quality – specifying
 - Quality criteria and standards expected
 - How the organisation will (for example), as necessary/required:
 - Improve its quality
 - Maintain its quality
 - Build quality into the production process
 - Speed – identifying:
 - Acceptable or target times for service delivery
 - Action to be taken to attain these targets
 - Dependability – detailing:
 - The criteria which determine reliability of product/service from the customer's perspective
 - How the organisation intends ensuring promises made about products and services are kept/honoured
 - Flexibility – explaining:
 - Ways in which the business will be prepared/able to customise the provision of products and services to suit individual need
 - New or different variations in products and services so there is a better match with identified customer demand
 - Cost – detailing possible areas such as:
 - Productivity targets for individuals, departments and/or the business
 - Margins required from different products/services or departments/divisions.
- Note: these five performance objectives:
 - Will be generated to accommodate external factors (demand or preferences of customers) and internal factors (what it is the organisation seeks to achieve)
 - Are often weighted or prioritised – in that one (or two, or three) of the five may have greater importance/relevance than the other(s)
 - May be driven by the market (customer demand) or by the organisation in terms of the resources it has available to it
 - Can relate to a competitive strategy where the organisation focuses on a factor where it has a unique advantage (an USP).



Websites

Read more at:

- <http://www.scribd.com/doc/64899080/Difference-Between-Policy-and-Strategy#scribd> – Difference between policy and strategy
- <http://www.executive.org/bibliography/policy.pdf> - What is policy? Strategic and operational policies and good governance
- <http://nraombakc.blogspot.com.au/2011/12/content-and-process-of-operations.html> - The content and process of operations strategy
- http://www.som.cranfield.ac.uk/som/dinamic-content/media/knowledgeinterchange/themedareas/innovation/key%20concepts/Bob_Lillis/index.htm - The process and content of operations strategy
- <http://www.business.gov.au/business-topics/business-planning/marketing/Pages/5-ps-of-marketing.aspx> - The 5Ps of marketing.



Format

There is no universally accepted format for the way in which operational policies and strategies are presented.

Organisations may:

- Produce a simple single page document for each policy
- Produce a simple single page document for each strategy
Some believe this is all that is necessary providing it covers all relevant requirements. In practice, people are more likely to read (and remember and follow/adhere to) a briefer policy than a longer and more complex one
- Produce a unique document for a specific/important product or service
- Use a Style Guide – with approved templates, examples and production guidelines to assist with preparing operational policies and strategies (and procedures).

Operational examples

It is a general requirement all operational policies and strategies developed need to be approved by management before they can be implemented.

Policies

Operational policies are often developed for the topics listed below:

- The environment – which may target:
 - Committing to the concept of 'sustainability'
 - Reducing general/total waste
 - Introducing recycling of waste
 - Lowering power/utilities use

- Products and services – which may target:
 - Generating new SOPs for production of items
 - Revising protocols for delivery of nominated services
 - Introducing new products and/or services
 - Setting criteria and standards for targeted products and services
 - Re-positioning/re-branding existing products and/or services in the marketplace
 - Eliminating products and/or services which have reached the end of their life cycle
- Training – which may target:
 - Determining training needs for all or selected workers or departments
 - Conducting non-accredited internal training on the basis of the results from TNAs
 - Using external providers to deliver identified accredited training courses
 - Ensuring all staff in nominated departments achieve a minimum standard of relevant formal qualifications
- Workplace relations – which may target:
 - Describing minimum qualifications for workers for nominated positions
 - Ensuring equity and diversity in staff recruitment and selection
 - Guaranteeing professional development for the workforce
 - Providing counselling and support for employees
 - Requiring respect for others
- Finance – which may target:
 - Authorising use of funds and resources
 - Operating bank accounts and investments
 - Paying creditors
 - Borrowing
 - Collecting debts
 - Purchasing
- Asset management – which may target:
 - Classifying assets
 - Specifying authority to purchase or acquire assets
 - Recording of assets
 - Using the Assets Register
 - Identifying asset management responsibilities
 - Stocktaking
 - Maintaining and securing assets.



Strategies

Operational strategies are often developed to address:

- Client development – which may target:
 - Increasing the number of actual users/customers/people who buy from the business
 - Adding names to a 'Prospects List'
 - Growing the list of contacts on the CMS database
 - Developing a new target market
 - Transferring existing customers into new products and/or services
- Geographic expansion – which may target:
 - Entering new markets in identified countries
 - Going global via online activities
 - Starting up offices or agencies in new towns and/or countries
 - Partnering with an existing company in identified 'other countries' or locations
- Organisational growth – which may target:
 - Building new building or refurbishing existing buildings
 - Increasing staff numbers
 - Adding new departments to the organisational structure
 - Becoming a public/registered company
 - Generating additional revenue/sales
 - Introducing new products and services to the product mix
 - Acquiring other/nominated businesses
 - Entering new markets
- Service growth – which may target:
 - Lifting service standards/criteria
 - Introducing new services
 - Improving service delivery
 - Adding extra services to existing services/products
- Debt reduction – which may target:
 - Decreasing overall debt
 - Obtaining lower interest rates for monies owed
 - Paying off nominated loans
 - Negotiating better deals for selected debts with nominated creditors
- Income development – which may target:
 - Increasing sales by volume/quantity of products/services sold
 - Increasing sales using a nominated monetary unit
 - Increasing profit by lowering costs
 - Lowering costs by negotiating better deals with suppliers
 - Lowering costs by identifying less expensive but suitable alternative raw materials.



Websites

Read more at:

- <http://policies.uws.edu.au/view.current.php?id=00086> – Asset management policy
- <http://www.business.vic.gov.au/money-profit-and-accounting/financial-processes-and-procedures/accounting-and-financial-policies-and-procedures> - Accounting and financial policies and procedures
- <https://mifosforge.jira.com/wiki/display/docs/Operational+Policy+Samples+for+Financial+Institutions> – Operational policy samples for financial institutions
- <http://www.templatezone.com/download-free-ebook/office-policy-manual-reference-guide.pdf> - How to write a policy manual
- <http://smallbusiness.chron.com/operations-strategy-examples-24650.html> - Operations strategy examples
- <http://www.referenceforbusiness.com/management/Ob-Or/Operations-Strategy.html> - Operations strategy.



Monitoring workplace need

It is possible to monitor workplace need as follows when determining need for operational policies and strategies:

- Encourage staff to identify areas for attention through a selection of communication and feedback mechanisms – such as Suggestion Boxes, staff meetings, ‘open door’ policy by management towards staff suggestions
- Assess *actual* business performance (KPIs) against projected outcomes – to determine areas that require attention
- Observe worker practice – comparing the competency being displayed and seeking operational issues impacting (as appropriate) service provision or product production
- Conduct workplace inspections – to determine the level of compliance with externally imposed legislated requirements as these apply to (for example) safety, environmental management, employment regulations and similar
- Analyse workplace accidents and incidents – to identify if the causes indicate a need for action
- Evaluate feedback received from customers – regarding complaints about service/products, suggestions for improvements and positive comments.

Monitoring opportunities for improvements and innovation

Monitoring to determine opportunities for improvements and innovation should:

- Consider the *internal* environment – of the organisation, by looking inwards towards what is happening within the business in terms of (for example):
 - New, different and/or updated skills held by staff
 - New, different and/or updated equipment and/or production processes
 - New, different and/or updated financial resources
 - New, different and/or updated knowledge
 - Changes which may have been made to organisational plans
 - Alterations to business targets, goals and objectives
 - Identified actual (or potential) issues related to accidents, injury, error, near misses, complaints, compliments, faults, defects and failure to attain projected targets
- Consider the *external* environment – of the business environment in which the organisation operates in terms of (for example):
 - New markets – emerging as new products are invented/developed and/or as 'old' products finish their life cycle
 - Shifts in customer needs, wants and preferences – as these alter over time given the dynamic nature of public demand
 - Action being taken by competitors – such as new products being introduced into the market or promotional activities to attract business
 - Changes to legislation – which cause mandatory alterations to products/services and/or the way the organisation is forced to conduct its operations
 - New technologies – which introduce an opportunity to provide a service or produce a product in a novel, more efficient, less expensive or better way.



See more on internal and external factors in section 1.3.

1.2 Develop scope and objectives of the required initiative based on enterprise goals, staff and customer feedback

Introduction

In order for policies to be genuinely effective there is a non-negotiable need for them to be suitably described and quantified.

This section expands on initial information presented in the previous section and presents detail which needs to be addressed when developing identified initiatives.

Required initiatives

In this context 'required initiatives' can be seen as any action to be taken by the organisation to:

- Address an identified operational threat or weakness
- Capitalise on an identified strength or opportunity.



Scope

'Scope' refers to the *limitations* which apply to a policy.

The scope of a policy therefore:

- Defines its reach
- Restricts its use
- Prescribes the framework and context in which it is to be applied.

In practice the scope for a policy may be:

- A named individual or nominated group of individuals – instead of *all* employees, persons or customers
- A certain department or area of an organisation – instead of *all* workplace divisions
- A specific office or agency of the organisation – instead of *all* physical locations
- A stated time of the year – which may be described by dates or in some other industry-appropriate or industry-relevant manner
- A geographic location – such as a given country, region or destination
- Time-related – detailing times of the day when the policy applies, and times when it does not.

Objectives

'Objectives' for a policy refer to the aims of the policy.

The objectives should:

- Quantify issues which are central to the policy – and which are to be evaluated in terms of:
 - Milestones/KPIs – as the policy is implemented
 - Final analysis of performance
- Set dates – when the policy:
 - Starts
 - Assesses milestones/KPIs
 - Finishes
 - Is reviewed.



SMART objectives

One approach to writing objectives (and goals) is to follow/apply the SMART acronym, where:

- S = Specific: the objectives must be clearly spelled out/described so there is no confusion
- M = Measurable: there must be some metric/way of measuring/quantifying progress towards/attainment of the objective
- A = Attainable (or Achievable): the target set must be something that can be done
- R = Realistic (or Relevant): the topic that is the focus of the policy must be something to which the organisation is committed and is genuinely committed to
- T = Time-related (or Tangible): there must be a finite timeframe attached.

Topics

In organisations objectives may be set for a wide range of services and products.

Traditionally it is easier to write objectives for products as they are tangible objects which are easier to measure and analyse, but services too will often need to have objectives written for them.

Commonly, organisations prepare objectives for policies addressing:

- Sales figures – in terms of units sold
- Revenues – in terms of money earned/generated
- Delivery times – which may refer to speed of delivery and the percentage of 'on time' deliveries
- Service standards – with reference to established criteria (as set by the organisation, or with reference to an industry benchmark or accepted industry standard) for each individual aspect of service delivery

- Client numbers – which may be classified in terms of (for example):
 - New customers
 - Repeat customers
 - Converted customers – that is, customers who transition from ‘enquiries’ into ‘sales’ or who move from ‘prospects’ to ‘purchasers’
- Sales figures and targets – which can be specified by:
 - Product or service type
 - Name of individual staff member
 - Department or other physical location
 - Target market type, as defined by the business
- Booking levels – which can be stated with reference to:
 - Physical numbers
 - Specific products, services and/or target markets
 - Conversions
 - Percentage accompanied by advance/holding deposit
 - Refunds and withdrawals
- Customer feedback – which may be:
 - Separated into ‘Compliments’ and ‘Criticisms’
 - Rated on a ‘Customer Satisfaction’ score/index
- Staff feedback – which is often classified:
 - By number
 - With reference to topic/focus of the feedback (management; operational issues; remunerations; working conditions)
- Productivity – measuring (in a useful way to the organisation) the relationship between inputs to the production process and the resulting outputs.



Websites

See the following for more:

- <http://www.leoisaac.com/policy/top131.htm> - Policy goals and objectives
- <http://www.fao.org/wairdocs/ilri/x5499e/x5499e04.htm> - Examples of objectives for a company
- <http://www.businessdictionary.com/definition/objective.html> - Objectives defined
- <http://topachievement.com/smart.html> - Creating SMART goals

1.3 Identify and analyse internal and external factors that may impact on the policy

Introduction

An essential element of developing operational policies is to identify and analyse internal and external factors which may impact the policy.

This section introduces the concept of different analyses which may be used to determine these factors and presents and discusses a range of possible factors.



Undertaking workplace analysis

A range of options is available to identify and analyse the internal and external factors that impact policy initiatives.

Commonly a business will only use one option to determine their situation.

A formal analysis is the preferred/recommended course of action as this will:

- Demonstrate personal professionalism towards the proposal and (may) discharge due diligence requirements
- Be the most likely strategy for identifying and gaining a proper/full appreciation of all relevant factors.

SWOT analysis

A SWOT analysis is a well-known and respected strategic planning tool.

It is the process of gathering together information/data on both the internal and external environments of the organisation to determine the strengths, weaknesses, opportunities that are present as well as the threats relating to the situation being considered – in this case, the development of a specific policy.

A SWOT analysis is a fundamental pre-requisite for any research to help determine the situation being considered.

Internal factors

The internal factors in a SWOT analysis are the factors present *within* the organisation.

They are the 'Strengths' and 'Weaknesses' of the entity.

What is classified as a Strength for one business may well be a Weakness for another.

For example:

- One business may have loads of cash reserved to fund whatever is the focus of the policy, while another could be cash-poor
- One organisation may have a detailed *knowledge* of the topic which is the focus for the policy while another operator knows little/nothing in this regard.

These factors are sometimes referred to as 'controllable' as organisations have the power to impact them – they can (for example) take action to raise more money or obtain additional resources and work to gain more experience regarding the issue/policy topic being considered.

External factors

External factors are those which exist *outside* the business.

They are divided into:

- Opportunities – which are factors which can be exploited or taken advantage of in relation to the development of a policy or an initiative
- Threats – which represent things which might prejudice, jeopardise or otherwise negatively influence the development of a policy or an initiative.



External factors are regarded as being ‘uncontrollable’ in that the business/entity undertaking the analysis is unable to (significantly) impact the relevant factors.

Other approaches

Other ways to view/consider the **external** factors impacting a business are to use SLEPT or PESTEL analysis of the situation.

SLEPT analysis involves consideration of:

- Social factors
- Legal factors
- Economic factors
- Political factors
- Technological factors.

PESTEL analysis is the same as SLEPT but with the addition of ‘Environmental’ factors.

STEEPLE analysis adds consideration of Ethics.

Websites

Take time to read articles as follows:

- http://www.mindtools.com/pages/article/newTMC_05.htm - SWOT analysis
- <https://www.business.qld.gov.au/business/starting/market-customer-research/swot-analysis/example-swot-analysis> - Example SWOT analysis
- <http://smallbusiness.chron.com/swot-analysis-diversity-training-1850.html> - SWOT analysis on diversity training
- <http://pestleanalysis.com/> - PESTLE analysis
- <http://www.slideshare.net/lconner/steeple> - STEEPLE analysis.



Examples of factors

Capabilities and resources

The capabilities of the organisation to deliver services and produce products, and the resources it has to support these activities are all internal factors.

Specific factors may be:

- Human resources – this relates to issues such as:
 - Number of staff available within the business
 - Pool of potential employees the organisation is able to recruit from
 - Experience and expertise of employees/staff skill and knowledge levels
 - Payment being sought by workers
 - Degree of fit between staff profiles and profiles of target markets
- Financial resources – which relates to:
 - Amount of cash reserved held by the company
 - Amount of loans the business is able to access
 - Contributions which can be sourced from 'other sources' such as government agencies, joint venture partners, or industry organisations
 - Interest rates and costs of borrowing/money
- Equipment capacity – with reference to:
 - Production capacity of current plant and machinery
 - Safety status of items
 - Potential to modify equipment to meet changing/changed market needs and/or projected new inventory requirements for the business
- Communication capabilities of the organisation – in terms of being able to:
 - Solicit feedback from customers
 - Generate contributions from other stakeholders
 - Notify target markets of initiatives and innovations
- Position of the organisation – which relates to:
 - Physical/geographic location of the business in terms of offices, outlets, agencies
 - The hours of operation of the business
 - Different ways customers can interact with/buy from the organisation – including online options for providing information, responding to queries and making sales and accepting payments.



Trends and developments in the marketplace

These are all external factors as individual organisations have little or no influence on them.

Economic considerations

Analysis of the economic considerations in which the business operates may address matters such as:

- The local economic environment as well as the economic state of other countries from which the business draws its customers
- Inflation
- Interest rates
- Exchange rates
- Levels of employment and unemployment
- Availability of local skilled/competent staff
- Amount of discretionary income customers have
- Community thoughts on the state and/or future of the economy.



Environmental considerations

Analysis of environmental considerations/factors could include:

- Sustainability issues
- Use of power and water
- Rubbish disposal
- Pollution – traffic, noise, air, water
- The impact of the venue on local communities.



Governmental/political considerations

Analysis of governmental/political factors may consider:

- The political stability of the country
- Is a change of government imminent and if so what implications can be expected?
- Feelings in relation to international trade/dealings
- Political relationships between home country and other countries
- The support available from government (agencies and bodies) for industry and/or initiatives.

Social and cultural considerations

Analysis of social and cultural factors could include:

- What image does the industry have in the eyes of society? Is it a positive image? Is it tarnished for some reason and if so how/why?
- Projected responses of local and other communities if the business pursues various options – such as entering into a relationship with a certain organisation, entering into a new market, erecting a new building
- The status of the business in the eyes of the community/public as a 'corporate citizen'
- Mobility of people and their ability to travel to and from the venue/organisation.

Demographic considerations

Analysis of demographic factors could include:

- Are customers getting older or younger?
- What is the ratio of males to females? Is this changing?
- Are there increasing or decreasing domestic and/or international customers?
- Which countries are customers coming from?
- Are customers increasingly (or decreasingly) single, married, and married with children?



Technological considerations

Analysis of technological considerations could include:

- Does the current technology being used by the business remain effective and efficient?
- Is there new technology in the marketplace which can/should be used to:
 - Improve business performance/save time and/or money?
 - Provide better/different facilities for customers and perhaps give the organisation a USP or meet identified customer demand/meet competition?
- Does legislation require use of nominated technology? When?
- What is the cost of new/required technology and what are supply/purchase options?
- Dangers or problems inherent in adopting new technology and/or integrating it into existing systems and/or processes.



Industrial considerations

Analysis of industrial considerations could include:

- Level of unionisation of workforce
- Conditions of employment for workers
- Triggers for industrial unrest.

Comparative market information

These factors relate to the issues and applicable details as they relate to:

- Best practice information – for:
 - The industry or industry sector
 - Services delivered
 - The extent to which the organisation wants to align with nominated 'Best practice' protocols
- Benchmarking – with reference to:
 - Identifying the other industries or businesses with which comparisons will be made
 - Describing the metrics which will be used for comparison purposes
 - Determining how relevant data will be collected and compared

- Competitor information – with reference to:
 - Prices being charged by them
 - Their trading hours and locations
 - Special deals being offered
 - Quality and characteristics of their products and services
 - Promotions they are undertaking
 - The staff they are using to deliver services/produce products
 - Their market share
 - Impact they are having on the business.

See more at:

- <http://study.com/academy/lesson/what-is-benchmarking-definition-types-process-examples.html> - What is benchmarking?
- <http://www.tutor2u.net/business/strategy/benchmarking.htm> - Benchmarking
- http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Best_practice - Best practice



Legal considerations

Legal considerations will relate to:

- Complying with relevant legislation
- Ensuring adherence with contractual obligations
- Adhering to mandatory Codes of Practice/Conduct
- Liaising with authorities to seek advice and direction on what is legally permissible
- Discharging 'duty of care' and 'due diligence' obligations
- Involving external legal practitioners to evaluate and advise on operations and initiatives
- Ensuring customers are suitably advised about changes to products and services, and terms and conditions of trade.

Ethical considerations

Ethical considerations will relate to:

- Ensuring fairness and equity
- Maintaining safety and security
- Child protection
- Retaining transparency and accountability
- Guaranteeing sustainability
- Addressing environmental issues
- Preserving community
- Testing and proving the safety of initiatives prior to release
- Promoting the local country, buying locally and supporting local employment.



1.4 Consult appropriate stakeholders during the development of the policy

Introduction

All relevant stakeholders must be consulted as a standard element of policy development.

This section identifies who stakeholders may be and presents options for consultation with them.

Key stakeholders

Stakeholders in the development of operational policies will vary depending on:

- Company size and structure
- Previous experience/engagement with the development of formal organisational documentation such as plans, policies, strategies and procedures
- Urgency attached to the need to produce a particular policy
- The importance of the policy being considered
- Partnership arrangements and working agreements which exist between the organisation and other businesses.

In overview key stakeholders may include:

- Customers – standard practice is to establish a ‘representative sample’ of the profile of the organisation’s customers
- Employees – from all departments/areas to which the individual policy applies or relates
- Government agencies – who may:
 - Request involvement
 - Have a mandated interest
 - Be able to make valuable contributions
- Owners – and/or The Board of Management within the organisation
- Investors – and shareholders
- Suppliers – who:
 - May be impacted by policy decisions
 - Are critical to pivotal policy decisions
- Strategic alliance partners – who:
 - Are involved in operations flowing from policy decisions
 - Will want to have their interests reflected in policies which are developed
 - Need to be kept advised in order to maintain a cohesive, working and mutually beneficial business partnership.



Consultation

Identify initial requirements/preferences

When seeking to consult with stakeholders it may be advisable to:

- Determine/define the reason for the consultation
- Determine their preferred method of consultations
- Identify the times/days they have available for consultation/to attend meetings
- Work out how they prefer their information to be provided to them
- Determine the level of formality/informality of the consultations preferred or required
- Generate a range of ways in which stakeholders can contribute
- Pitch information at the known level/s of stakeholders
- Include a feedback loop/facility for all communications which occur as part of the consultation process
- Determine how the outcomes from the consultation process can be effectively shared among others
- Develop a communications plan to support the overall process.

Options

Strategies for consultations may include:

- Use of focus groups – for customers
- Face-to-face meetings and workshops – with individuals and/or groups, featuring:
 - Presentations
 - Discussions
 - Decision making
- Telephone contact
- Email communications
- Posting information on designated websites
- Provision of hard copy materials
- De-briefing sessions following use of first-hand experiential techniques – such as:
 - Receiving proposed services
 - Tasting planned food and beverages products
 - Visiting proposed destinations and venues.



1.5 Develop administrative framework and systems capable of supporting the planned initiative

Introduction

It is important to ensure all required resources are available to underpin implementation of a planned initiative/policy.

This section presents points to note regarding the development of resource strategies and discusses considerations in relation to their appropriateness and financial-soundness.



Resource strategies

In relation to resource strategies it is necessary understand:

- Some policies and initiatives will not have resource strategies developed for them – smaller organisations and small projects often do not need or use resource strategies for every single policy/initiative
- Where resource strategies are used, they are likely to be developed for each classification of resources to be used:
 - Financial resources
 - Human resources
 - Physical resources – which may include intellectual property or knowledge relating to the operation of the business such as statistics, information, recipes, SOPs and operational protocols
- Exactly what constitutes a resource strategy is likely to vary between organisations – these is not a standard template for these strategies and it is possible/probable:
 - Not all strategies will identify the *source* of resources
 - Some may only address use of resources
 - Others will cover both the above aspects.

Financial resource strategy

It is to be expected the financial resource strategy for an initiative might address:

- The total amount of money available for the project
- Contributions made by individual sources (consolidated funds, contributions by individual departments or offices/agencies, borrowings/loans, shareholders, government grants and similar
- Names of people – with:
 - Authority to access/spend the identified funds
 - Responsibility for monitoring and reporting
- Times which apply to use of the money – for example:
 - Dates when funds become available
 - Dates by which funds must be spent



- Limits regarding what money can be spent on
- Need for quotations to be obtained – for expenses over a given amount
- Requirement for money to be spent with ‘preferred suppliers/providers’ where possible.

Human resource strategy

It is to be expected the HR strategy for an initiative might address:

- Names of staff to be involved – or who have been allocated to the initiative
- Number of hours for each staff member – or each department/division
- Classification of employees – by:
 - Employment status
 - Job title/position
- A budget for staffing – which may be based on:
 - Hours
 - A monetary figure
 - A department/office contribution
 - Definition and treatment of relevant on costs
- Training available for nominated employees – in relation to the initiative
- Identification of new staff to be recruited
- Secondment of employees to the project
- Incentives/remuneration adjustments to be paid to those working on the initiative – where/if applicable (such as ‘higher duties’ payments)
- Considerations in relation to internal succession planning for the organisation
- Alignment of HR actions and decisions with umbrella HR plans.



Physical resource strategy

It is to be expected the physical resource strategy for an initiative might address:

- Types and quantities of resources available
- Location of resources
- Identification of resources which have been contributed by partners/external sources
- Where resources which need to be obtained can or must be sourced
- Specification of what is to happen with physical resources when the initiative is complete – for example, disposed of/thrown out, sold, given to charity, returned to XYZ
- Where and how certain resources may/must be used
- Monitoring of resource usage
- Accountability for usage.



‘Appropriate and financially-sound’ strategies

‘Appropriate and financially-sound’ resource strategies may be seen as those which:

- Have been approved by management
- Satisfy requirements of key stakeholders
- Provide suitable resources in sufficient quantities
- Are safe to use/implement
- Comply with all legislated obligations
- Align with company goals, objectives, higher-level plans and public statements
- Make resources available when needed
- Conform with budgetary limitations
- Have been subjected to required analysis – which may include:
 - Cost-Benefit analysis
 - ROI
- Have contingency plans developed for them.



Websites

Take the time to read:

- http://www.mindtools.com/pages/article/newTED_08.htm - Cost-Benefit analysis
- <http://management.about.com/cs/money/a/CostBenefit.htm> - Cost Benefit analysis
- <https://www.business-case-analysis.com/return-on-investment.html> - ROI explained



1.6 Develop administrative framework and systems capable of supporting the planned initiative

Introduction

An essential consideration when developing policies to support an initiative is the need to ensure the availability of a necessary supporting framework and systems.

This section identifies and discusses examples of components of the infrastructure which may be considered.



Definitions

Infrastructure

Infrastructure in this context can be seen as:

- Systems necessary to support implementation of policies and initiatives
- Facilities required to enable required administrative work to be conducted for the policies and initiatives.

Administrative work

‘Administrative work’ can be seen as the activities required to:

- Supervise and manage the project – to enable suitable implementation of policy and conduct of the initiative
- Track and monitor activities – so there is oversight of all nominated aspects and progress is examined to identify variations from projections/expectations at the earliest opportunity so corrective action can be taken
- Record action taken – so an accurate and up-to-date database of information is established and maintained for the project
- Report on progress – using factual data to form the basis of information sharing to relevant stakeholders.

Practical requirements

In order to create an effective administrative framework and systems capable of supporting a planned initiative it can be necessary to:

- Identify and allocate roles for the initiative – so there is clarity regarding responsibilities for action required
- Determine documentation to be used – which may mean:
 - Developing new forms
 - Deciding on the use of existing internal paperwork
- Verify KPIs and planned objectives have been addressed – to ensure all aspects of the policy/initiative can be covered by administrative duties
- Implement relevant risk management – as appropriate to issues where this action is deemed necessary

- Prescribe reporting protocols – with reference to:
 - Timing of reports
 - Nature of the reporting mechanism/s
- Generate scopes of authority for policy-specific issues
- Train staff – in required practices as they apply to the initiative
- Ensure safety provisions – for all aspects of the project
- Decide on security protocols – to safeguard information captured/generated by administration
- Set up suitable data/information gathering options and procedures – to ensure all identified materials are captured and recorded
- Establish a viable communication plan – to exchange information between stakeholders
- Create a system for users and customers to provide feedback – if they:
 - Identify a problem or issue
 - Have a suggestion/recommendation to make.



1.7 Identify and communicate clearly all priorities, responsibilities and timelines

Introduction

The details of operational policies, strategies and/or initiatives which have been developed will need to be communicated to relevant stakeholders.

This section recaps those who may be 'relevant stakeholders', discusses the content of this communication and presents guidelines for communication.



Relevant stakeholders

Those who may need to be communicated with will vary with the focus of the policy/initiative but may include (as identified in more detail in section 1.4:

- Customers
- Employees
- Government agencies
- Owners and/or The Board of Management within the organisation
- Investors and shareholders
- Suppliers
- Strategic alliance partners.

Content of the communication

When communicating with stakeholders there is a need to:

- Present the *purpose* of the operational initiative **and** also explain *why* it will be beneficial/has been introduced
- Give staff everything relevant to the initiative and the applicable to their area of work – which *might* include:
 - Copies of plans from which policies flowed
 - Copies of standards which apply to the initiative
 - Copies of all relevant policies
 - Copies of procedures which are based on the policies
- Identify dates relevant to the policy – which will commonly relate to:
 - Implementation and introducing the initiative
 - Transitional periods
 - Dates for evaluation of KPIs
 - Review dates
 - Monitoring activities
 - Reporting

- Completion
- Final analysis
- Separate and prioritise elements of the policy (where applicable) – so stakeholders understand the relative importance for each of the components
- Detail the allocated roles and responsibilities – which attach to individuals under the policy
- Explain any new/changed scopes of authority – which attach to roles and responsibilities created under the policy
- Inform of training provided to support implementation of the policy/project
- Encourage questions about the operational policy
- Be available – for later discussions if individuals have concerns/need more detail
- Include new policies in applicable workplace documents – such as operational manuals, induction programs and in-house training.

Guidelines for communication

The communication of new (or revised) operational policies (or strategies or initiatives) may occur in various ways.

Keys

Keys to communicating are:

- The communication must be planned – effective communication never ‘just happens’
- The communication method/medium preferred by the stakeholder should be used – to demonstrate respect for their stated preferences
- Communications should be pitched at the level of the recipient – to optimise likelihood of people reading and understanding what is being provided
- A track must be kept of those who are contacted – so a record of the communication is maintained and/or available
- Follow-up must occur – in situations where:
 - There is difficulty contacting a person
 - Questions/issues are raised
 - More information/explanation is requested.



Strategies

Strategies to follow include:

- Hold a formal meeting (or series of meetings) to inform stakeholders of the operational initiative – this could/should feature:
 - Verbal explanation
 - PowerPoint presentation
 - Hard copy handouts
 - A Q&A session
- Speak to key stakeholders on a one-on-one basis – to personalise the delivery and allow a more individualised approach.

This may include face-to-face discussions with external and internal people, as appropriate to the nature of the policy/initiative

- Provide hard copy documents – without more formal contact, which may mean:
 - Mailing documents to recipients
 - Hand-delivering documents
 - Posting documents on restricted access intranet sites
- Use electronic options – where these have been indicated as a preferred communication option.

Include attachments of documents as necessary.



1.8 Develop evaluation systems in consultation with appropriate colleagues

Introduction

It should be standard practice to evaluate all operational policies developed by the organisation.

‘Appropriate colleagues’

The procedures to be used when evaluating a policy should be developed in consultation with ‘appropriate colleagues’.

These should/could be:

- Those who were involved in developing the policy
- Staff with responsibility for applying/implementing the policy
- Those who were impacted by the operation of the policy.



Note: some organisations will separate the functions of *development* of policy from the *evaluation* of policy believing this approach helps avoid people with vested interests covering up (or ‘fudging’) unsatisfactory/unacceptable outcomes.

Policy evaluations

Evaluation defined

‘Evaluation’ in this context may be seen as a systematic gathering and analysis of information (data, opinions, fact, statistics) to allow evidence-based judgements to be made about the extent to which a policy has been effective, appropriate and/or efficient when compared to its original objective/s.

Reasons to evaluate policies

It is important to evaluate operational policies in order to:

- Determine their effectiveness
- Learn lessons which may be able to be transferred to other policies and/or other areas
- Maintain alignment with compliance obligations
- Demonstrate and discharge ‘due diligence’
- Change ineffective policies so they become more effective
- Monitor responsibility and accountability issues relevant to the focus of the policy
- Avoid a situation where ineffective policies become entrenched as standard
- Decide the future for the policy – with options being:
 - Leave the policy ‘as is’
 - Amend one or more aspects of the policy
 - Delete the policy from operational use.

Points to note about the evaluation process

It is worth noting:

- Dates for evaluation/s should be established as part of the policy development process – to a schedule is set and the evaluation aspect is not forgotten/overlooked
- A policy can be evaluated while it is still being implemented/used – the evaluation does not have to wait until the policy has been retired
- The development phase should include establishing the criteria which will be used for the evaluation – these are commonly stated in/inherent within:
 - Objectives for the policy/initiative
 - KPIs
 - The more tightly written these two elements are, the easier it will be to conduct the evaluation as the standards for the evaluation will be more certain/obvious
- A combination of evaluation approaches achieves optimum results – as opposed to relying only on one method of evaluation: see following section
- The evaluation process for policies is often a balancing act – in that:
 - There is often little time or funds available for the evaluation process
 - Subjective evidence is easy to acquire but may introduce unacceptable bias in the outcomes deduced
 - Objective data based on scientific/mathematical precepts can be (too) costly and time consuming to produce given the importance of the policy
- Times change – an operational policy may have been professionally and expertly developed six months ago but be inappropriate to the internal and external conditions which apply *now*.



This highlights not all criteria which should be used to determine the effectiveness of a policy may have been included when the policy was written

- A report on the evaluation should be produced – with appropriate recommendations based on the available data/information
- Results/findings should be shared – in order that:
 - There is transparency regarding occurrences
 - The organisation supports a learning culture characterised by continuous improvement.

Evaluation procedures

Procedures which may be used to evaluate operational policies can include:

- Analysing stories and anecdotal evidence regarding a range of issues such as:
 - Impact of the policy
 - Ease/difficulty in implementing aspects of it/all of it
 - Feedback received
- Developing and administering series of questions or a questionnaire – to elicit information on the factors deemed by the stakeholders to be important to the evaluation process
- Undertaking empirical analysis – which may feature:
 - Comparisons of quantifiable projected and actual data – as set out in the KPIs and objectives for the policy/initiative
 - Statistical manipulation – where certain data is manipulated to produce results deemed relevant for the purpose of the activity.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

Note: this Work Project forms the basis for following Work Projects

To fulfil the requirements of the Work Projects for this Unit you are required to identify a workplace to be approved by your Trainer/Assessor and base responses to the Work Projects on this organisation.

1.1 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are required to develop operational policies providing evidence you have:

- Developed operational policies and strategies based on monitoring of workplace needs and identification of opportunities for improvement and innovation
- Developed scope and objectives of the required initiative based on enterprise goals, staff and customer feedback
- Identified and analysed internal and external factors that may impact on the policy
- Consulted appropriate stakeholders during the development of the policy
- Developed appropriate and financially-sound resource strategies
- Developed administrative framework and systems capable of supporting the planned initiative
- Identified and communicated clearly all priorities, responsibilities and timelines
- Developed evaluation systems in consultation with appropriate colleagues.

Summary

Develop operational policies

When developing operational policies:

- Obtain and read relevant plans for the organisation and to which the policies relate
- Make sure policies reflect the aims and intentions of the plans
- Realise procedures and practices will flow from the policies
- Understand operational policies relate to day-to-date actions and decisions which need to be taken
- Ensure they represent the philosophy of the organisation
- Write them to provide direction and guidance to employees
- Involve relevant stakeholders
- Provide clarity
- Obtain management approval prior to their introduction
- Consider using internal templates as the basis for writing them
- Prepare them for identified topics based on analysis of actual workplace need
- Generate appropriate scope and objectives for each
- Factor in all relevant internal and external factors impacting the organisation and implementation of the policy
- Support them with effective resource strategies
- Ensure supportive framework and systems to enable the policies
- Communicate approved policies to all those with responsibilities under them
- Develop evaluation protocols for each policy

Element 2: Administer and monitor operational policy

2.1 Implement and evaluate identified actions in accordance with agreed priorities

Introduction

When operational policies have been developed and confirmed for implementation by management the next step is to implement them.

This section presents considerations and activities inherent in the implementation and primary evaluation processes.



Key factors

Key factors in relation to implementation of operational policies are:

- An implementation plan *may* be prepared – for the introduction/implementation of a policy.

This is SOP for the introduction/implementation of many workplace initiatives but **not so common** where policies are concerned unless they are *major* policies with *significant* expected impact across a very wide range of people and/or issues.

- A suitable and receptive environment needs to be created in the workplace – where:
 - Those impacted are well disposed to the initiative
 - People are made aware of an inclusive orientation to the introduction so they understand their opinions and feedback are sought and will be listened to
 - Effective procedures and protocols have been established where necessary to enable effective implementation of the policy
 - Everyone knows possible risks/problems have been identified and preparations taken to manage those situations
 - Management (not workers) is seen as accountable – but they are reliant on support and cooperation from others
- The policies *must* be **initially** implemented **totally** as planned – and as stated in the policy document.

If policies do not succeed ‘as planned’ it is important to know the fault lies with the policy and the way it was developed or written, and not in the way it was put into practice.

- Initial implementation must be monitored – to determine if immediate changes need to be made to the plans for implementation/the policy itself based on:
 - Issues arising/emerging
 - Obvious unintended and/or unforeseen consequences

- Corrective action needs to be taken when obvious need to do so is identified – as opposed to waiting for scheduled reviews and analysis which may be listed for weeks or months into the future: see ‘Considerations in relation to primary evaluation’ below.

Considerations and activities in relation to implementation

When implementing a new (or revised) operational workplace policy it is important to:

- Have senior management make a public statement – which:
 - Recognises and shows support for the policy
 - Encourages compliance with its requirements
 - Extols the virtues and benefits of the initiative
- Ensure all resources (financial, physical, human and knowledge/information-based) are available – in accordance with:
 - Research
 - Plan
 - Promises made
- Check all those impacted by the policy have been informed – which may take the form of:
 - A formal briefing
 - Verbal explanation
 - Handouts of documentation
 - Training, practice and role plays
- Adhere to the promised/projected schedule for implementation – as this may apply to:
 - Implementation/start dates
 - Transitional periods/phases
 - Milestones for reviews
- Be available to provide necessary and assistance – to those impacted by the initiative so they can:
 - Obtain more detail as/when required
 - Seek clarification or guidance on ambiguous matters/issues
 - Show support for those with operational responsibility
- Encourage adherence to the requirements of the policy – through a range of actions such as:
 - Congratulating and thanking those who comply
 - Demonstrating personal compliance with what is required
 - Motivating individuals as needed
 - Never ignoring instances of non-compliance



- Verify the policy is functionally compliant with all necessary related obligations – as these may occur in terms of:
 - Occupational safety and health
 - Legal liability as specific to the individual policy
 - Promises/statements made in regard to product and/or service delivery
- Ensure required administrative activities are being undertaken in relation to the initiative – as these may apply with reference to:
 - Scheduled/required monitoring activities
 - Recording of action taken, money spent and feedback received
 - Reporting
- Action is taken to create a workplace environment supportive of the change – which may require attention being paid to:
 - Handling disruptions caused to normal operation/SOPs
 - Reassuring those initially (adversely) impacted by the initiative
 - Showing appropriate leadership and remaining positive/being enthusiastic about the implementation
 - Highlighting positive outcomes of the new/revised policy
- Engage with those who are to be impacted – which (in addition to other relevant topics already identified) may mean:
 - Setting personal objectives for individuals
 - Setting sub-targets of larger goals
 - Managing how individuals interact with requirements of the policy including dealing with common obstacles through conflict management, negotiation and explanation.

Considerations and activities in relation to primary evaluation

Context and rationale

‘Primary evaluation’ in this context refers to management activities undertaken to monitor the very first stages (hours, days, weeks) of a new policy.

This standard procedure applies/should be in place to:

- Demonstrate ongoing management engagement with and investment in the policy initiative – as opposed to allowing others to believe management has no further interest in the initiative
- Ensure **obvious and immediate negative outcomes** from the introduction of the policy are identified as quickly as possible – so appropriate remedial/corrective action can be taken.

Essentially this is done to stop bad situations getting worse

- Leverage any **obvious and immediate positive results** which emerge – so they can be applied/transferred to other areas
- Allow unexpected factors which are influencing or nuancing the implementation to be identified at the earliest opportunity – so that an appropriate response can be developed.



Examples of 'primary evaluation' monitoring action

A combination of the following could/should be used when undertaking primary evaluation monitoring activities:

- Engaging in personal observation – of practice and procedures in the workplace:
 - Judging reality against perceptions of what was expected
 - Looking at the impact of the policy on service delivery and the people impacted/involved
 - Putting the initiative into perspective by setting it against other relevant or competing factors
- Analysing documentation – which could include:
 - Evaluating mandatory reports/forms which are completed as part of the policy/initiative
 - Looking at results/outcomes represented in the documentation
 - Reading compliance reports
- Meeting with stakeholders – which could involve:
 - Conducting end of shift/day de-briefings with employees
 - Soliciting and analysing customer feedback
 - Encouraging and interpreting employee feedback
 - Holding formal meetings
- Reviewing short-term KPIs – which needs to address:
 - Evaluating extent to which they are being met/attained
 - Determining if **on the basis of hindsight** the KPIs were realistic
 - Undertaking formal gap analyses.



Websites

Take time to read the articles at:

- <http://2020projectmanagement.com/2013/05/how-gap-analysis-adds-value-to-your-business/> - How gap analysis adds value to your business
- http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Gap_analysis - Gap analysis

2.2 Monitor performance indicators

Introduction

In addition to the 'primary evaluation' of operational policy described in the previous section, there is also a need to undertake a more formal monitoring of performance indicators.

This section presents timing of this activity, identifies examples of performance indicators and discusses review of KPIs.



Timing

The 'primary evaluation' described earlier occurs in the first hours, days or weeks of the implementation of an operational policy.

The monitoring of performance indicators (or key performance indicators [KPIs]) may occur:

- In terms of a single month
- After several (two or three) months
- At a date identified in the plan for the operational policy.

Note: it is SOP where significant variations are identified in the 'primary evaluation' the tendency is for the more formal monitoring activities to be moved forward.

Examples of performance indicators

The KPIs which need to be evaluated must be the KPIs identified and as stated in the original policy.

It is possible KPIs can relate or apply to the following although the way they might apply will very much depend on the context and content of the individual policy as it is written:

- Sales figures
- ROI
- Growth
- Profitability
- Processes
- Personnel
- Turnaround times
- Output rates
- Quality rates
- Customer feedback
- Equipment usage rates
- Lead times and down times
- Compliments-complaints ratio



- CSI
- Debt servicing costs.

Reviewing Key Performance Indicators

There are a number of ways to review the relevance and effectiveness of KPI's including but not limited to:

- Discussing KPIs with key stakeholders
- Reviewing each KPI to ensure it is still accurate
- Reviewing 'required level of achievement' for each KPI
- Checking level of success against current KPIs
- Identifying reasons why KPI's have or have not been met
- Determine if KPIs need to be amended
- Making recommendations for changes where amendments are required.



Websites

It is useful to look at the articles presented at:

- http://www.admin.ox.ac.uk/media/global/wwwadminoxacuk/localsites/estatesservices/documents/capitalprojectsforms/KPI_Process_Guidance_Note.pdf - The KPI evaluation process
- <http://www.learnmanagement2.com/Key%20Performance%20Indicators.htm> – KPIs



2.3 Provide progress and other reports in accordance with enterprise requirements

Introduction

Standard practice within organisations is the requirement for the production and circulation of reports regarding the implementation and effectiveness of operational policies.

This section provides basic requirements in relation to these reports, suggests methods for sharing report information and identifies matters which should be highlighted as part of the process.



Basic requirements

The basic requirements for reports on the implementation of operational policies are they must:

- Be fair and accurate – they must be truthful, telling the ‘bad’ as well as the ‘good’
- Be based on facts – as opposed to being based on supposition, opinion and ‘hope’
- Not be personal in nature – that is, they should not aim to be vindictive about a person/group of people
- Be produced and circulated by the date identified in the plan for implementation – each time the need for a report is mentioned.

There can also be a need for:

- An Initial/Introductory report
- Interim report/s
- Final report
- Only be released for discussion to those who have been approved to receive them – usually this means only those designated on an authorised Distribution List, as these reports are often regarded as being Commercial in Confidence.

Methods for sharing report information

Every enterprise is likely to have its own protocols for the sharing of information/the distribution of internal reports and SOP is to adhere to whatever practice is in common usage within the organisation.

Those who receive the reports should be asked to keep the contents of the reports private.



Common options for sharing these reports include:

- Holding team meetings and disseminating information at staff briefings – to share information within operational teams/workers
- Distributing hard copy information – to identified stakeholders
- Sharing information via the intranet – using ‘Password protected’ protocols to limit access only to nominated persons

- Providing formal face-to-face group presentations with stakeholders – supplemented by hard copy handouts, explanations and Q&A sessions.

Matters which should be highlighted

Matters which may be highlighted in these reports are potentially numerous but special attention should be paid to:

- Explaining if the operational policy is working or not – and quantifying the outcome (if possible)
- Identifying the reasons why it is working or not working – drawing direct links between 'cause and effect'
- Significant variations from KPIs/projections – and coverage of the factors associated with those variances changes
- Unusual results – and determination of their causes
- Strengths and opportunities – which have emerged from the initiative
- Weaknesses and potential areas for improvement – as indicated by the evidence captured
- Impact/implications of the results and conclusions – on projected future performance of the organisation.



2.4 Make assessment of the need for additional resource requirements and take appropriate action in accordance with enterprise policy

Introduction

An essential aspect of monitoring activities is the need to determine whether or not policy implementation can be improved if additional resources are provided to support the initiative.

This section looks at the importance of this stage and gives examples of options which may be appropriate.



Importance of this stage

Context

Where important information about a policy/initiative has been revealed as a result of the monitoring undertaken there is commonly a need to revise and adjust the initiative in response.

When responding it is vital action taken:

- Aligns with higher level plans
- Conforms to all other/related enterprise policies
- Is approved by management prior to implementation
- Results in necessary changes to all SOPs which are directly related to the changes made to the policy.

Need for this phase

It is important to revise and adjust policies to:

- Factor in new and emerging information – which would simply not have been available when the original policy was written
- Maintain credibility with stakeholders – who will expect the organisation to be taking some action in response to implementation of a new or revised policy
- Align with internal obligations imposed on managers and/or management teams – most managers or management teams will be under a formal responsibility to take action as/where necessary to revise and adjust policies on the basis of evidence derives as a result of monitoring activities
- Exploit positive results – and minimise adverse impacts
- Demonstrate responsible management – and discharge requirements relating to due diligence (if these requirements have not been specifically stipulated/spelled out by the organisation)
- Prove ongoing engagement with the initiative and/or the policy – in a practical/hands-on way.

Options for action

The basic options for possible action in response to monitoring evidence/data are:

- (1) Do something – see ‘Responding to positive outcomes’ and ‘Responding to negative outcomes’ in section 3.3
- (2) Do nothing – doing nothing **is a valid in response in some cases** but *it must be a **considered and rational** decision to do so* and not just a default position because people cannot be bothered taking action.

Precisely *what* is done will depend on:

- Whether the results are ‘positive’ or ‘negative’, when compared to the projections/indicators
- Other relevant/new issues which have emerged – as part of the monitoring/implementation process.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

Note: this Work Project follows from Work Project 1.1

2.1 For the organisation/workplace and operational policies identified in Work Project 1.1 administer and monitor operational policy providing evidence you have:

- Implemented and evaluated identified actions in accordance with agreed priorities
 - Monitored performance indicators
 - Provided progress and other reports in accordance with enterprise requirements
 - Made assessment of the need for additional resource requirements and take appropriate action in accordance with enterprise policy.
-

Summary

Administer and monitor operational policy

When administering and monitoring operational policy:

- Implement policies strictly in accordance with planned implementation
- Consider generating a plan for implementation
- Decide if a transitional introductory phase is required
- Ensure required/promised resources have been provided to support implementation
- Provide information and/or training to support implementation
- Be prepared to engage in primary evaluation when the policy is introduced
- Follow up primary evaluation with ongoing monitoring activities
- Check/evaluate KPIs
- Monitor and evaluate implementation in accordance with plans
- Report on the findings of monitoring activities
- Determine the need for extra or revised resource provision as the policy is implemented

Element 3:

Conduct ongoing evaluation

3.1 Review the operational policy to assess effectiveness in the workplace

Introduction

All operational policies must be reviewed as part of normal operating procedure.

This section discusses requirements in this regard.

Standard requirements

It must be a standard requirement all policies are:

- Reviewed at the date contained in the policy and set as the official review date – incorporation of this review date must be a mandatory part of the development of every policy
- Reviewed on some regular basis, regardless – such as:
 - Quarterly
 - Every six months
 - Annually
 - In synchronisation with the business plan cycle for the organisation
- Reviewed when there has been an event deemed to be 'significant' in nature – this may be:
 - An incident or accident (or near miss)
 - A serious complaint or other nominated occurrence
 - Legal action
 - A major change in marketplace
- Reviewed by suitable persons – generally:
 - Those involved in the development of the policy
 - Those impacted by the policy
- Reviewed and revised according to a pre-determined process/plan – this is a written plan detailing and/or providing guidelines or requirements in relation to:
 - The aspects of the policy to be evaluated and/or given special attention
 - When evaluations will take place
 - How the evaluation will be conducted
 - Who will be involved in conducting evaluations
 - Documents, data and/or organisations which need to be investigated/researched as part of the review process.



Issues to address when reviewing

The review should/could address issues such as:

- What is the feedback from staff and other users in relation to the policies – for example:
 - Are they aware of the policy? Do they understand what it means and what they are expected to do in order to comply?
 - What do they think of the policy? Do they think the policy is good or bad/effective or ineffective? Why?
 - How do they impact/guide workplace activity?
 - Can they suggest improvements? What? Where?
- What are the comments from customers impacted by the policy – for example:
 - Do they understand the policy? Why? Why not?
 - Do they like it? Why? Why not?
 - How do they want it to change?
- Is there actual/genuine compliance with the policy – or:
 - Are staff/people simply ignoring the requirements?
 - Does evidence point to limited compliance 'some of the time' or 'only under certain circumstances'?
- What impact is being noticed on topics and targets relevant to the policy – for instance:
 - Are services being delivered more efficiently and/or effectively
 - Are sales and/or profits increasing?
 - Is the policy introducing an unacceptable or annoying barrier to standard workplace operation? How? Why? What can be done about this?
- What impact is being noticed on expenditure? Is there a drop/rise in productivity or (for example) use of materials as a result of new/revised workplace procedures?



Objectives of the review

The review may have specific aims as stated in the policy 'review' section, or there will be generic needs to determine:

- If the outcomes for the policy are actually being achieved
- What changes need to be made to bring an under-performing policy back on track
- Whether alterations need to be made to certain aspects of the policy to capitalise on better than expected performance of the business.

In general:

- Satisfactory outcomes lead to no action being taken
- Outcomes which are *significantly* above or below expectations lead to:
 - Revisions of policies
 - Modifications of other related policies
 - Changes to allied *procedures*.

3.2 Monitor performance

Introduction

Throughout the life of all operational policies their performance needs to be monitored to ensure they continue to produce the required results.

This section must be read in conjunction with section 3.2 and presents considerations which may need to be observed in this regard.



Aim of monitoring performance

The aim of monitoring business performance can be seen as to:

- Identifying policy areas which are adhered to/implemented as required or intended
- Rewarding and/or acknowledging compliant behaviour
- Identifying where areas of policy can be improved through:
 - Identification of problems
 - Understanding cause/s of issues
 - Finding suitable solutions to identified problems/issues
 - Generating a viable solution.

Relevant points to consider

When monitoring the performance of an operational policy on an ongoing basis the following need to be taken into account:

- Fact-based/real evidence **must** be generated as a result of the monitoring processes – so:
 - There is direct relevant of the data to the policy
 - Objective ‘proof’ can be used for analysis and decision making
- The monitoring process should be an **ongoing** process – which means:
 - Compiling *cumulative* data/evidence
 - Not just gathering evidence on set dates or at ‘one point’ in time
- Definite responsibility must be allocated for monitoring activities – so:
 - Nominated roles/persons have clear obligations
 - Required actions are clearly identified
- Sufficient resources need to be provided – to:
 - Enable sufficient and relevant monitoring to occur
 - Ensure there is sufficient ‘time’ to do what is required

- Attention must be paid to obtaining 360° feedback – that is, there should be data, evidence and/or input from:
 - Those *impacted* by the policy
 - Those expected to *implement* the policy
- Training may need to be provided to those who have responsibility for monitoring – it can never be assumed the responsible person automatically knows:
 - What to do
 - How to do it
- The context for the activity must be a foremost consideration – meaning:
 - Times change
 - It is critical the monitoring process factors in the reality ‘of the moment’ and the relevant internal and external factors which apply at the time
- The process should seek to produce two classifications of data – in particular:
 - Quantitative data
 - Qualitative information
- The process should generate comparative data – that will compare projected or anticipated targets against actual outcomes
- There *may* be a restriction on the number of policies which can be/have to be monitored – in some cases:
 - Not all policies will have to be monitored
 - There may be a priority list of policies which need to be monitored
- Effort must be made to identify reasons for results which are generated – so:
 - The causes of outcomes can be determined
 - Actual causes are used as the basis for further thinking and (where appropriate) decision making and action
- The policy being monitored must be seen as part of ‘the bigger picture’ – that is, the way other policies are performing, so that an overall picture of organisational performance is obtained
- Records should be generated and maintained regarding the monitoring process – so they:
 - Can be shared with others
 - Are available for future/further reference
- The monitoring activity/activities are not an end in themselves – it is to be expected the information generated from the process leads to some form of intentional action.



3.3 Identify problems and make adjustments accordingly

Introduction

A primary reason for evaluating policies is so that problems can be identified and suitable adjustments made to enhance the effectiveness of policies, where needed.

This section looks at options for making adjustments in response to evaluation findings.

Making no changes

Making no changes at all to a policy can be a legitimate response in some cases where evaluations determine:

- The policy is working as required/expected – and everyone is satisfied with the outcomes being produced
- The results being generated are satisfactory enough – and do not warrant extra time, energy or resources being spent trying to improve them or their outcomes
- There needs to be more time given to the policy/initiative to see how things turn out in the longer run – in reality, perhaps the initiative has not had long enough to enable any valid conclusions to be drawn *at this stage*.

Note taking no action is an acceptable and responsible response where it is a *reasoned* one – this response is not acceptable where it is applied simply because people cannot be bothered doing anything else.

Responding to positive outcomes

Actions may include:

- Reviewing and revising policies – to:
 - Create enhanced objectives supported by what the data says
 - Expand goals
 - Increase participants
 - Extend timelines and the timeframe for the policy
- Endorsing the *existing* policies – with a view to reproducing the previous results during the next monitoring/research cycle.

This is acceptable where everyone is happy with things ‘as they are’ and do not want extra growth, revenue, productivity or other positive indicators

- Producing revised/enhanced targets for outcomes – seeking to increase results for the next/designated time period or milestone



- Continuing support for initiatives /elements which have generated these results – in terms of:
 - Funding – which may be:
 - Maintained at current level
 - Increased to support expansion of the policy/initiative
 - Changed with reference to source of the money, access to funds, timing of availability of cash
 - Moral support – from management and stakeholders to:
 - Encourage continued implementation/commitment
 - Acknowledge the compliance already received from those impacted by the policy
 - Other resources – which may mean:
 - Providing extra staff and/or physical resources to support growth
 - Supplying more hours for personnel to demonstrate required compliance
 - Arranging for more or different physical resources
 - Changing the mix of employees involved in implementation
 - Altering supply protocols for physical resources
- Transferring lessons learned – as a result of these policies/initiatives to:
 - Other topics within the organisation
 - Other programs, proposals or initiatives
- Promoting success – by:
 - Celebrating with those who implement the policy and are responsible for its success
 - Congratulating personnel
 - Rewarding designated/key as/if deemed appropriate
- Developing associated policies – which:
 - Expand the focus of the *other policies* on the basis of lessons learned from *this policy*
 - Extend the scope of the initial policy – so its impacts and benefits are more widespread.



Responding to negative outcomes

Actions may include:

- Holding a formal enquiry into the outcomes – which should:
 - Involve those who implement the policy and are impacted by it
 - Include all stakeholders
 - Check/confirm/verify the conclusions
 - Evaluate and interrogate the analysis which has produced the negative outcome
- Conducting additional or different *research* – to:
 - Identify if results/outcomes are different
 - Determine whether monitoring techniques and data collection is the reason for the outcomes
- Undertaking different data *analysis* techniques – to:
 - See if the outcomes differ
 - See if previous results are confirmed
 - Confirm previous results **or** generate legitimate *alternative* data/outcomes
- Reviewing and revising policies – to:
 - Alter allocation of responsibilities of key persons especially where it is believed there is a demonstrable need to do so – that is, some people have not performed as expected/required and it is suspected this has caused the negative outcome
 - Amend/reduce targets
 - Increase funding/resources – to help achieve initial targets
 - Reduce funding/resources – to reflect the reduced outcomes
 - Provide more time for objectives to be achieved – if lack of time is assessed as being the cause of the negative outcome
 - Include/upgrade risk management protocols relating to the policy
- Providing more training to participants – which may involve:
 - Supplying formal training – addressing (as required/requested) training in knowledge related to the policy/initiative
 - Using role plays and practical exercises to demonstrate required implementation/s of the policy
- Conducting more or different promotion of the policy – in terms of:
 - Altering the way the policy is being promoted internally to those who have to abide by it – by (perhaps) assisting with re-wording the policy, changing entries in staff handbooks and/or amending intranet postings brochures
 - Revising and reinforcing the way the new/revised policy is presented to users – in terms of explanations and rationales given to staff/users



- Apologising and explaining the outcomes – to:
 - Users
 - Stakeholders
- Accepting the outcomes and being satisfied with the less-than-expected results – in terms of:
 - Acknowledging the results which have been achieved are nonetheless beneficial despite failing to achieve the targets set
 - Understanding the impacts of the initiative were *starting* to become acceptable even though the positive expectations were not being achieved
- Abolishing the policy – and:
 - Considering an alternative policy
 - Waiting for a later/different time to re-introduce the original policy/initiative
 - Deciding, on balance, the benefits of trying to persist with the policy are not justified in terms of the negative outcomes which are being realised.



3.4 Incorporate the results of evaluation into ongoing planning and operational management

Introduction

Standard practice in relation to the evaluation of workplace operational policies is the need to incorporate the results of evaluations into ongoing planning and day-to-day management.

This section presents a range of possible requirements of this final stage of the overall policy management process.



Standing requirements

The following are always non-negotiable elements/considerations – all action taken:

- Must feature collaboration with relevant stakeholders
- Must be based on fact and the results of evidence-based analysis
- Need to generate an improvement to the current situation
- Must address identified need and/or deficiencies
- Have to be cost-effective
- Must be viable, legal and practical
- Must feature use of version control protocols to ensure correct version is being used at any point in time
- Must be approved by management prior to implementation.

Examples of action which may be taken

Incorporating results of policy evaluations into ongoing planning and operational management may result in:

- Re-writing existing policies – to prepare 'revised' policies which address:
 - Previous errors or omissions
 - Identified policy gaps
- Circulating 'draft' for comment – prior to confirming them as endorsed
- Scrapping 'old' and/or unsatisfactory or un-workable policies - and writing new/replacement ones which may:
 - Address new issues
 - Feature benchmarking
 - Update applicable criteria/standards
- Deleting dated/irrelevant policies – and not replacing them



- Applying applicable quality control procedures – which may involve:
 - Compliance with organisational style guide
 - Adherence to organisation-wide QA protocols
- Introducing new policies – to address identified and legitimate emerging requirements/need
- Promoting awareness of policies in the workplace in a better manner/differently – so there is greater understanding regarding what is required
- Enhancing and/or altering monitoring of compliance with policies in the workplace – so users are more compelled to adhere to requirements of the policies
- Updating workplace databases and/or handbooks – so they contain the updated/current version of policies
- Incorporating new/revised policies into standard workplace protocols – in terms of, for example:
 - Inclusion into internal workplace training courses
 - Integrating into Induction and Orientation programs
- Circulating copies of the new/revised policy – using hard copies and electronic options
- Preparing/developing new or revised SOPs – to reflect the changed policy requirements
- Organising and presenting relevant presentations – to all necessary levels/users within the organisation which may require/entail, as appropriate:
 - Introducing, explaining and demonstrating implementation of the policy
 - Conducting supplementary information and training sessions
 - Holding staff briefings
 - Including articles in internal newsletters and posting on bulletin boards
- Revising records management – to ensure all necessary information is captured and maintained for reference/use as required.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

Note: this Work Project follows from the previous Work Project.

3.1 For the organisation/workplace and policies previously identified conduct ongoing evaluation of those policies providing evidence you have:

- Reviewed the operational policy to assess effectiveness in the workplace
 - Monitored performance
 - Identified problems and made adjustments accordingly
 - Incorporated the results of evaluation into ongoing planning and operational management.
-

Summary

Conduct ongoing evaluation

When conducting ongoing evaluation:

- Review policies in accordance with scheduled evaluation dates/times
- Focus on determining effectiveness of the policies
- Engage with policy users and those impacted by the policies
- Follow a formal plan/process
- Be prepared to take action where required/as necessary
- Realise taking no action is sometimes an acceptable response to some evaluations
- Continue to focus on organisational performance during the evaluation
- Reward/acknowledge compliant behaviour
- Generate cumulative data to use as the basis for the evaluation
- Capture objective evidence to use in the evaluation process
- Identify problems based on actual proof
- Respond to the causes of positive and negative outcomes
- Factor in lessons learned from the evaluations into ongoing planning and operational management

Presentation of written work

1. Introduction

It is important for students to present carefully prepared written work. Written presentation in industry must be professional in appearance and accurate in content. If students develop good writing skills whilst studying, they are able to easily transfer those skills to the workplace.

2. Style



Students should write in a style that is simple and concise. Short sentences and paragraphs are easier to read and understand. It helps to write a plan and at least one draft of the written work so that the final product will be well organised. The points presented will then follow a logical sequence and be relevant. Students should frequently refer to the question asked, to keep 'on track'. Teachers recognise and are critical of work that does not answer the question, or is 'padded' with irrelevant material. In summary, remember to:

- Plan ahead
- Be clear and concise
- Answer the question
- Proofread the final draft.

3. Presenting Written Work

Types of written work

Students may be asked to write:

- Short and long reports
- Essays
- Records of interviews
- Questionnaires
- Business letters
- Resumes.



Format

All written work should be presented on A4 paper, single-sided with a left-hand margin. If work is word-processed, one-and-a-half or double spacing should be used. Handwritten work must be legible and should also be well spaced to allow for ease of reading. New paragraphs should not be indented but should be separated by a space. Pages must be numbered. If headings are also to be numbered, students should use a logical and sequential system of numbering.

Cover Sheet

All written work should be submitted with a cover sheet stapled to the front that contains:

- The student's name and student number
- The name of the class/unit
- The due date of the work
- The title of the work
- The teacher's name
- A signed declaration that the work does not involve plagiarism.

Keeping a Copy

Students must keep a copy of the written work in case it is lost. This rarely happens but it can be disastrous if a copy has not been kept.

Inclusive language

This means language that includes every section of the population. For instance, if a student were to write 'A nurse is responsible for the patients in her care at all times' it would be implying that all nurses are female and would be excluding male nurses.

Examples of appropriate language are shown on the right:

Mankind	<i>Humankind</i>
Barman/maid	<i>Bar attendant</i>
Host/hostess	<i>Host</i>
Waiter/waitress	<i>Waiter or waiting staff</i>

Recommended reading

Certo, Samuel C *Supervision: concepts and skill-building* (Ninth edition). New York, NY McGraw-Hill Education, 2016

Ferrell, O. C & Hirt, Geoffrey A & Ferrell, Linda 2016, *Business: a changing world*, Tenth edition, New York, NY McGraw-Hill Education

Johnston, R & Clark G, 2008 (3rd Edition); *Service Operations Management*; Pearson Education

Kusluvan Salih; 2003 (1st edition); *Managing employee attitudes and behaviours in the tourism and hospitality*; Nove Science Publishers, New York

Lashley, Conrad, Morrison, Alison; 2001 (1st edition); *In Search of Hospitality (Hospitality, Leisure and Tourism)*; Butterworth-Heinemann

Maynard, Therese H; 2010 (1st edition); *Business Planning*; Aspen Publishers

Mondy, R. Wayne & Martocchio, Joseph J 2016, *Human resource management*, 14e [edition], Upper Saddle River Pearson

Waddell, Dianne & Jones, Gareth R & George, Jennifer M 2013, *Contemporary management*, 2nd ed, McGraw-Hill Australia, North Ryde, N.S.W

Trainee evaluation sheet

Develop and implement operational policies

The following statements are about the competency you have just completed.

Please tick the appropriate box	Agree	Don't Know	Do Not Agree	Does Not Apply
There was too much in this competency to cover without rushing.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Most of the competency seemed relevant to me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency was at the right level for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I got enough help from my trainer.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The amount of activities was sufficient.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency allowed me to use my own initiative.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My training was well-organised.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer had time to answer my questions.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I understood how I was going to be assessed.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I was given enough time to practice.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer feedback was useful.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Enough equipment was available and it worked well.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The activities were too hard for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐

The best things about this unit were:

The worst things about this unit were:

The things you should change in this unit are:



Trainee self-assessment checklist

As an indicator to your Trainer/Assessor of your readiness for assessment in this unit please complete the following and hand to your Trainer/Assessor.

Develop and implement operational policies

		Yes	No*
Element 1: : Develop operational policies			
1.1	Develop operational polices and strategies based on monitoring of workplace needs and identification of opportunities for improvement and innovation	☐	☐
1.2	Develop scope and objectives of the required initiative based on enterprise goals, staff and customer feedback	☐	☐
1.3	Identify and analyse internal and external factors that may impact on the policy	☐	☐
1.4	Consult appropriate stakeholders during the development of the policy	☐	☐
1.5	Develop appropriate and financially-sound resource strategies	☐	☐
1.6	Develop administrative framework and systems capable of supporting the planned initiative	☐	☐
1.7	Identify and communicate clearly all priorities, responsibilities and timelines	☐	☐
1.8	Develop evaluation systems in consultation with appropriate colleagues	☐	☐
Element 2: Administer and monitor operational policy			
2.1	Implement and evaluate identified actions in accordance with agreed priorities	☐	☐
2.2	Monitor performance indicators	☐	☐
2.3	Provide progress and other reports in accordance with enterprise requirements	☐	☐
2.4	Make assessment of the need for additional resource requirements and take appropriate action in accordance with enterprise policy	☐	☐

		Yes	No*
Element 3: : Conduct ongoing evaluation			
3.1	Review the operational policy to assess effectiveness in the workplace	☐	☐
3.2	Monitor performance	☐	☐
3.3	Identify problems and make adjustments accordingly	☐	☐
3.4	Incorporate the results of evaluation into ongoing planning and operational management	☐	☐

Statement by Trainee:

I believe I am ready to be assessed on the following as indicated above:

Signed: _____

Date: _____

Note:

For all boxes where a **No*** is ticked, please provide details of the extra steps or work you need to do to become ready for assessment.

